

Colorado Cups – State, Presidents, Centennial, U12 Rising 11v11

Rules and Procedures

I. Tournament Overview

- a. State Cup is ran each year in the Fall and Spring season to declare a winner in each age group as part of the US Youth Soccer (USYS) pathway for National Championship Series. Winners in U12 and older will advance to a regional or national competition operated by USYS.
- b. Presidents Cup is ran each year in the Fall and Spring season to declare a winner in each age group as part of the US Youth Soccer (USYS) pathway for National Presidents Cup Series. Winners in U13 and older will advance to a regional or national competition operated by USYS.
- c. Centennial Cup is ran each year in the Fall and Spring season for Advanced League teams in Elite-Bronze that do not wish to enter State or Presidents Cup. Winners do not progress to any regional or national competition.
- d. U12 Rising 11v11 is held each Spring season for Advanced League teams of any division that wish to gain experience playing 11v11 ahead of their progression to the U13 age group in the following seasonal year. For the purposes of these rules, the U12 Rising 11v11 event will follow the same rules as the U13 age group for State, Presidents, and Centennial Cup.

II. Team/Player Eligibility & Roster Building

- a. Eligible Teams:
 - i. Only Colorado-based teams that play in CSA-operated leagues (National 1 League, Advanced League, Front Range League, and Mountain Region League) are eligible for Colorado Cups.
 - ii. U11–U12 has a maximum roster size of 18 players (16 players may suit up for each game)
 - iii. U13–U19 has a maximum roster size of 22 players (18 may suit up for each game)
 - iv. Roster are frozen no later than 4 calendar days prior to the first scheduled match.
 - v. Teams may only play in one age group and competition per seasonal year. If a team plays in the Fall season in any of the cups, they are not eligible to re-enter the competition in a different age group in the Spring season.
- b. Eligible Players:
 - i. A player may only be rostered with one team across all cup competitions in one seasonal year.
 - ii. Guest players are NOT allowed. A club may issue a club pass to any youth player who is a registered youth player of the club before the team to which such youth player is to be rostered. Each player with a club pass will be assigned to a team roster. Any team found to have substituted ineligible players on a roster will forfeit their games at this tournament and may be subject to further sanctions.
- c. Eligible Coaches/Team Staff:
 - i. A maximum of 4 coaches and/or club staff members are permitted on the roster and on the sideline at games. Eligibility to be present on the sideline; the staff member must be assigned to the frozen cup roster or have a coaching pass from PlayMetrics for the current seasonal year showing that they have completed all risk management requirements.
- d. If a team withdraws after being accepted into the competition, their entry fee will be forfeited.

III. Competition Format & Seeding

- a. Fall age groups will include: Boys U12 & U14 and Girls U12, U14, U15, U16, U17, & U18/19
- b. Spring age groups will include: Boys U11, U13, U15, U16, U17, & U18/19 and Girls U11 & U13
- c. Teams will be seeded into their flight in the following order:
 - i. Defending national champion
 - ii. Defending regional champion
 - iii. Defending state champion

- iv. Using the CSA league standings of the last completed season in the following order:
 - 1. Premier 1 of an older age group (in the event the team played up into an older age group in league)
 - 2. Premier 1 of the cup age group
 - 3. Steps 1 and 2 above will be repeated, in order, for the divisions beneath Premier 1 (beginning with Premier 2, Premier 3, and so on)
- d. The following bracket structure will be used based on the number of teams. Play-in games will be played if necessary to bring the number of teams to the nearest even number (with the exception of 3-, 5-, 9-, and 13-team flights; in the case of these brackets, efforts will be made to get an additional team to register to bring it to a 4-, 6-, 10-, or 14-team flight, but will move forward without a play-in game if a team cannot be found).
 - i. 1 team – Automatic Champion
 - ii. 2 teams – Teams play each other twice; Most points winner
 - iii. 3 teams – One bracket of 3; Round robin; Two games each; Most points winner
 - iv. 4 teams – One bracket of 4; Round robin; Top two to final
 - v. 5 teams – One bracket of 5; Round robin; Four games each; Most points winner
 - vi. 6 teams – Two brackets of 3; Two games in bracket with one crossover (1v6, 2v5, 3v4); Bracket winners to final
 - vii. 8 teams – Two brackets of 4; Round robin; Bracket winners to final
 - viii. 9 teams – Three groups of 3; Round robin; Group winners and top 2nd place team advance to semifinals, 5th through 8th place wildcards play consolation; 9th place wildcard given partial refund of 33%
 - ix. 10 teams – One bracket of 4 & two bracket of 3; Bracket of 4 plays round robin, Two brackets of 3 play two games in bracket with one crossover (2v9, 3v8, 4v5); Bracket winners and wildcard to semifinals (A1vWC, B1vC1 (reseeded to A1vC1, B1vWC if WC comes from A))
 - x. 12 teams – Three brackets of 4; Round robin; Bracket winners and wildcard to semifinals (A1vWC, B1vC1 (reseeded to A1vC1, B1vWC if WC comes from A))
 - xi. 13 teams – One group of 4 & three groups of 3 each play round robin; group winners advance to semifinals, 2nd & 3rd place teams from 3-team brackets play consolation game
 - xii. 14 teams – Two brackets of 4 & two brackets of 3; Brackets of 4 play round robin, Two brackets of 3 play two games in bracket with one crossover (3v12, 4v11, 5v6); Bracket winners to semifinals (A1vD1, B1vC1)
 - xiii. 16 teams – Four brackets of 4; Round robin; Bracket winners to semifinals (A1vD1, B1vC1)

IV. Match Rules & Laws of the Game

- a. All games shall be played in accordance with the most current FIFA Laws of the Game with the modifications by CSA listed below. Situations that are not covered by these rules or rules of CSA or cannot be reasonably resolved in a timely fashion by application of these rules or the rules of CSA shall be resolved in the most expedient manner at the sole discretion of the Tournament Director or the Site Director.
- b. At the conclusion of the match, the Field Referee will complete the game card in detail. He/she will inform the CSA tournament staff of ejected participants for the Tournament records and any possible further action. He/she will also turn in an official supplemental game report if there are any unusual match circumstances to be reported.
- c. Law I – Field of Play
 - i. The penalty kick marks shall be:
 - 1. 8 yards from the goal line in all 9v9 games
 - 2. 12 yards from the goal line in all 11v11 games

- ii. During the progress of any game, all members of a team and the team's coaching staff shall remain in their designated team area while not on the field of play. All team members shall stay behind any drawn spectator line or at least five feet from the touch line, with the specific exceptions of players warming up prior to impending substitution or when the referee requests the presence of staff on the field to assist an injured player.
 - iii. Both teams shall be on the same side of the field, each team's area shall begin 10 yards from the halfway line and shall extend for a distance of 12 yards towards the appropriate goal line.
 - iv. All spectators shall remain at least five feet from touchlines or goal lines, unless drawn or erected spectator line establishes a different distance. Both teams shall be located on the same side of the field. Spectators of both teams shall occupy the opposite side of the field from their respective team and coaches. The only spectators permitted anywhere other than the primary spectator sideline (ie- behind the goal, on the end line) need prior permission from the tournament director. Any individual who remains in an area where they are not permitted is subject to ejection after one warning during the tournament.
 - v. Video cameras such as the Veo must be placed on the spectators' side with the feet or base no closer than 4 yards to the touchline.
 - vi. Drones, horns, whistles, large megaphones, or artificial noise makers are prohibited.
- d. Law II – Ball
 - i. Teams shall use the following ball sizes:
 - 1. U11 through U12 # 4 size ball
 - 2. U13 through U19 # 5 size ball
 - ii. Each team shall supply the referee with one or more suitable balls, properly inflated and in good condition. The referee shall choose the ball to be used in the game.
- e. Law III – Number of Players
 - i. The playing size shall be:
 - 1. U9–U10 is 7v7 (min number of players to start 5)
 - 2. U11–U12 is 9v9 (min number of players to start 6)
 - 3. U13–U15 is 11v11 (min number of players to start 7)
 - ii. A team shall have the minimum number of properly registered, uniformed players in order to start or continue any game. One of those players shall be designated as a goalkeeper. One of those players shall be designated as a goalkeeper.
 - iii. With the referee's permission, a team may substitute at any stoppage for any number of legal players.
 - iv. With the referee's permission, a team may substitute for a cautioned player at the time of the caution and the opposing team may substitute one player.
 - v. Players who wish to enter or re-enter the game shall enter the field only at the halfway line. They may not enter the field of play until the players whom they are replacing have completely cleared the field and the referee has specifically signaled permission to enter the field. With the referee's permission players leaving the field should do so at any point around the boundaries in order to minimize lost time.
 - vi. A team shall not replace a player who has been sent off for misconduct (ejected/red card). The team shall play short by the number of players sent off in the game for the remainder of that game.
- f. Law IV – Players Equipment
 - i. In all games, the team listed first on the official game schedule shall be the home team and they shall wear Dark jersey and the visiting team shall wear white or light.

- ii. All field players on the team shall wear similar color jerseys. The goalkeeper shall wear colors, which distinguish him/her from the other players and from the referee.
 - iii. The following items are not permitted:
 - 1. earrings of any kind (no tape, no bandages)
 - 2. jewelry of any sort, except noted below.
 - iv. The following are conditionally permitted:
 - 1. religious medals or medical tags, which are taped to the body.
 - 2. splints, casts, braces or other joint-support devices, which, in the referee's opinion, are not inherently dangerous or are padded with pliable materials to eliminate the dangerous condition.
 - v. Shin guards are required.
- g. Law V – The Referee and Law VI – Assistant Referee
 - i. One certified referee and two certified assistant referees will be used for all games when possible.
- h. Law VII – Duration of Games
 - i. The duration of matches shall be:
 - 1. U11-U12 2 x 30 minutes (5-minute halftime)
 - 2. U13-U14 2 x 35 minutes (5-minute halftime)
 - 3. U15-U16 2 x 40 minutes (5-minute halftime)
 - 4. U17-U19 2 x 45 minutes (5-minute halftime)
 - ii. Knockout stage games will extend to extra time and/or penalties if the game is tied after regulation. Extra time will only be played for the Final. Any preceding knockout rounds (semifinal, quarterfinal, etc.) will go straight to penalty kicks if tied after regulation. The duration of the extra-time period following a final tied at the end of regulation shall be:
 - 1. U11-U14 2 x 10 minutes (1-minute halftime)
 - 2. U15-U19 2 x 15 minutes (2-minute halftime)
 - iii. Each referee shall refrain from adding time for trifling stoppages or delays and shall make every effort to complete each game in accordance with the field schedule. Adding time is allowed for serious injuries.
- i. Law VIII – The Start of Play
 - i. Any team, which is not ready to start play with at least the minimum number of properly uniformed players, checked in with the referee at the scheduled or rescheduled game time, shall forfeit the game. Extraordinary circumstances beyond the team's control shall be considered at the sole discretion of the Tournament Director.
- j. Law IX – Fouls and Misconduct
 - i. Any player/coach sent off for using foul and abusive language for persisting in misconduct after being cautioned shall sit out the next scheduled tournament game. If sent off for violent conduct, the individual shall sit out a minimum of the next two tournament games. If any suspension imposed is not completely served in games of this tournament, the individual's pass and full report of the details of the incident shall be sent to CSA and forwarded to the club to complete the sit out requirements in the next CSA league game.
 - ii. Any coach, manager or spectator who has been ejected (red carded) must remove himself no less than 100 yards from the playing field within 5 minutes of notice of ejection or the match will be abandoned.
 - iii. In case of any incident of severe misconduct by participants or their supporters, the Site Director shall have the authority to convene a special hearing on the matter. The Hearing Committee may recommend special sanctions to the Tournament Director including but not limited to expulsion of any individual or a group from the tournament. A summary of any special hearing leading to

the recommendation of additional sanctions shall be forwarded to the home club and to CSA for review and appropriate action.

- iv. Prior to each game, It is the responsibility of the team representative to inform the referee of the name of an individual not participating in the game due to suspension. It is the responsibility of the referee to record that name (when informed) on the referee's game report.
 - v. Harassment or insult by word or action to any official or tournament staff member by any player, team representative or spectators will not be tolerated. Rostered players, team representatives or any individuals reasonably construed to be associated with a team are subject to disciplinary action by the Tournament Committee and CSA. Team representatives shall be held responsible for the conduct of their supporters. Other non-associated spectators who create a disturbance will be asked to leave, and if they refuse, they will be escorted from the premises by legal authorities.
- k. Law X – Free Kicks
- i. The distance to be given for free kicks shall be:
 - 1. U9-U12 8 yards
 - 2. U13-U15 10 yards

V. Scoring & Standings

- a. During the preliminary rounds of the tournament, games will not have overtime periods. Team standings will be based on the following point system:
 - i. 3 points for a win
 - ii. 1 point for a tie
 - iii. 0 points for a loss
 - iv. 1 point deducted if a bench personnel is dismissed (applied on a case-by-case basis)
 - v. 1 point deducted if a spectator is dismissed (applied on a case-by-case basis)
- b. A forfeit score will be entered a 3-0 scoreline.

VI. Tiebreakers

- a. Should there be a tie at the completion of the preliminary round that determines advancement, the tie will be broken by the following order of criteria:
 - i. Head-to-head (if more than two teams are tied, this will not be used).
 - ii. Goal Differential
 - iii. Goals Against
 - iv. Taking FIFA kicks from the mark.
- b. Note: If more than two teams are tied, the sequence will begin at Point "ii" and progress to Point "iii" if any teams are still tied.

VII. Knockout Rounds

- a. If a flight contains a wildcard that advances to the knockout rounds, this refers to the team with the highest points that did not otherwise advance as a group winner.
- b. The first round of knockout rounds will be reseeded should it contain a matchup that was played in pool play.

VIII. Discipline, Misconduct, & Protocol

- a. Penalties received by players/coaches in Cup Competition, be it red or yellow cards, will be served only within the context of Cup play, and will not carry over into League or Tournament play. If applicable, penalties will be served in Regional/National competition or carried over to the players/coaches next Cup enrollment regardless of their team affiliation. If the coach is participating in different Cups, the penalty will be applied to the event in which it occurred.
- b. If bench personnel (coach, assistant coach, DOC, trainer, ...) is dismissed from a particular game, he/she needs to sit out at least that particular team's next game and also is not allowed to participate in other club's games in any capacity in Cup until the sit out is served.

- c. If a game is abandoned due to coach/spectator/player, the team for which the coach/spectator/player is with shall forfeit the game and the other team awarded points based on the score or a 3-0 victory whichever is greater.
- d. If a player/coach/spectator is sent off/dismissed for misconduct, the referee will submit the game report to the Cup Committee or designated alternate. The player/coach/spectator shall be subjected to penalties described below and shall be ineligible until he or she is reinstated by Cup administration.

IX. Concussion Protocol

- a. If a player is evaluated by medical trainers present at the field and is found to exhibit concussion-like symptoms, Colorado Cup will adhere to the USYS Concussion Procedures and Protocol.
- b. The player will be evaluated by on-site medical trainers and if a suspected head injury is determined, a report will be given to a Cup designated staff member. The player and parents will receive information documents from the medical trainer and will need to be evaluated and cleared by a medical profession before participating in any further League or Cup matches. Once the clearance paperwork is sent to the CSA office, CSA will notify the club so the player can resume participation in League and Cup games.

X. Forfeits & No-Shows

- a. Any team that fails to appear for a single Cup game without the prior approval of CSA will be assessed a forfeit. A 3-0 scoreline will be entered against the team and CSA shall review the circumstances of the no show for possible disciplinary review and/or a fine of \$2,000.
- b. Games will kick off at the time shown on the tournament schedule. A 15-minute grace period will be allowed from the scheduled kickoff time. If a team is not ready to play at the end of the 15-minute grace period, the game will be forfeited and the point above will come into affect.

XI. Weather, Delays, Reschedules & Postponements

- a. Cup games shall take precedence over all other games, with the exception of National 1 League. Cup games may only be rescheduled if it conflicts with a National 1 League game.
- b. If a team makes the semifinal or final of Cup, they have permission to reschedule their league game the weekend of the Cup semifinal and/or final without penalty.
- c. Any game that is stopped for any cause except team fault will either be restarted at the time of stoppage on same day or rescheduled and played from the time of stoppage.
- d. Games may be canceled or temporarily suspended when fields are not playable due to rain, low air temperature, excessively high winds, or lightning.
- e. The responsibility of game cancellation, shortened games, or temporary suspension will rest with the tournament committee. Final judgment will be that of the Tournament Director or designated representative.
- f. In event that play has been stopped by the field Referee, Head Referee, or Tournament Director, the score at the stoppage of play will be the final game score if at least one half was completed and if play is not resumed as ordered by Tournament Director.
- g. In case of bad weather, a siren will sound for clearing the fields. When the siren is heard again, play will resume. Do not leave the complex until games are officially canceled. PARTICIPANTS AND SUPPORTERS SHOULD LEAVE THE PLAYING AREA AND GO DIRECTLY TO THEIR CARS.
- h. The Tournament Director or designated representative shall determine the suitability of playing conditions. Teams shall be expected to play in accordance with the tournament game schedule unless severe weather poses a threat to safety. Only the Tournament Director or designated representative shall reschedule the game times and/or locations. Games may be shortened or relocated to complete the days' schedule of play.

XII. Protests & Appeals

- a. To be valid and eligible for consideration, protests shall be lodged verbally with the referee and the opposing coach at the game site immediately after the end of the game, except protests relating to the

grounds, goal posts, bars, and their appurtenances of the game must be in writing and submitted to the Referee and opposing coach prior to the start of the game.

- b. All protests must be made in writing within two hours after the end of the game in which the protest incident occurred, accompanied by a non-refundable \$200.00 (cash) protest fee to the CSA Cup Committee or the Cup Committee's designated representative.
- c. The judgment decision of a game official cannot be protested, only the misapplication of the Laws of the Game.
- d. If these conditions are not met in full, the protest will not be considered.
- e. Upon receiving a properly filed protest, the CSA Cup Committee or designate will determine the time and location of the protest hearing and shall designate the members of the ad hoc protest committee. This committee will meet in a closed meeting to make a ruling on the protest. A hearing will be held immediately upon receiving filed protest and protest fee if it requires immediate action. Otherwise, a decision will be rendered within 48 hours.
- f. A plea of ignorance to the rules and regulations of the Cup competitions is not sufficient grounds for a protest or appeal. Violators may expect appropriate action by CSA.
- g. In Cup competitions at the State Association level, decisions made on protests and appeals by the CSA ad hoc protest committee and appeal authority are binding and allow the competition to proceed.
- h. Video evidence will not be considered.

XIII. Awards

- a. Awards and medals will given to teams that finish as champions and runners-up in their flight. See "Competition Format" for how champions and runners-up are determined based on the number of teams in the flight.

XIV. Alcoholic Beverages, Drugs of Abuse or other Controlled Substances

- a. Possession, consumption or use of any of these items at the field area by any coach, parent, referee, team official, league official or spectator prior to, during or after the play of any game at this tournament is prohibited. Any individual who violates this prohibition shall be subject to disciplinary action by CSA.

XV. Matters Not Covered

- a. Any matter not addressed in these rules will be decided by CSA. Decisions in such matters specific to CSA Cup – Grand Junction rules shall be final and binding.
- b. If a party has reasons to appeal against a decision made by CSA outside of what is covered within these rules, an appeal may be filed with the CSA Board of Directors, which must follow the appeal process as outlined within the CSA Rules & Procedures.

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